

Facebook at a theatre near you

'The Social network', a movie on popular social networking site Facebook is to be released on October 01, 2010

tridges. Apart from the seven colour cartridges there is a gloss optimizer (GO) cartridge. GO helps in reducing the effect of bronzing - a phenomenon where if you look at a glossy print from an angle, light will reflect differently on areas with little ink than from areas having lot of ink. R1900 allows

you to minimise this problem by spraying the entire print with a gloss optimiser spray. Installing the cartridges is quite straightforward. Setting up the printer is easy. The R1900 also has a provision to print CD and DVD covers. there is a separate tray to insert the cover paper.

Performance

R1900 performed well in most of the tests when it came to speed, but its quality was not as good as we expected from a printer having eight cartridges. We rechecked the cartridges to

see if the bundled cartridges were inserted in the correct slots. Inspite of that, we noticed a slightly dull printout. All the printer settings were at default. Photo 1 lacked contrast. Photo 3 which had human subjects appeared really nice though, with skin tones that weren't too bright, a problem we noted with many previous printers. Mixed document printing also strictly OK, nothing great to talk about in the quality of the print.

Price: ₹39,999

Conclusion

Epson Stylus Photo TX700W was awarded as the Best Performer for its fast, good quality print speeds. HP Photosmart printers gave good quality prints as well, but they took insane amount of time because of which they lost out in the performance scores. Moreover,

TX700W comes with myriad features like WiFi, Bluetooth and also functions like copier and scanner (no points were awarded for these functionalities though).

Best Buy was awarded to Canon iP3680 for its sweet price point of ₹5,595. Its performance outscored both the HP printers.

Apart from these printers, we felt that the pricing of Canon iP100 is way off the mark. It is ideal for someone who is constantly travelling and wants instant printouts. The additional battery provided with the printer can be a boon in places where there is no provision of direct power.

Epson R1900 is strictly meant for office use. It's not feasible for home use as it will need a large desk space plus it does not make economic sense to print A3 prints at home. 



Epson Stylus Photo R1900

Canon Selphy CP780

Ultra compact portable printers are flooding the market, thanks to digital cameras becoming a necessity in our lives. The joy of physically flipping through photo albums cannot be matched. Canon Selphy CP780 is one photo printer that can be used to quickly take 4x6 inch prints of your photographs either from the PictBridge port or the variety of memory card slots. The compact size makes this photo

printer extremely portable. It also has a provision to add an external battery, thus reducing the need for a power source. However, the model we tested was done using a power source. Canon Selphy CP780 comes in a white plastic body with a silver top portion. There is a 2.5 inch LCD screen which is surrounded by the operational panel buttons. The top portion has a wavy design making it quite attractive to look at. All the buttons like power, menu, back, print and navigation buttons are rubberised. The printer comes with two trays, one for a postcard size paper and the other for a visiting card size. These trays have a two way plastic panel acting as a lock. There is no output collection tray. On the right hand side is the slot to insert the ink rollers. It has PictBridge port on the left hand side whereas the memory

card slots populate the left hand corner on the front panel. It has support for SD/mini SD/MMC+/RS-MMC/CF/MS/MS Duo cards. Due to the compact size, this printer makes use of printing by dye sublimation technique. These print the photograph by passing the photo paper through the rollers four times, once each for each of the C,M,Y and the overcoat layer. It is fascinating to see the photograph being developed as it passes through the rollers and superimposing the individual colours to get the final output. The overcoat layer forms a thin laminative protective covering over the photo to prevent discolouration from UV light and air.

Performance

This printer is quick to print 4x6 prints. It took around 58 seconds

each to print the three test photos. The glossy paper that Canon bundled along with the ink cassette has perforations on either side. It is advisable to not get rid of the perforations till the photograph is printed. One thing that disappointed us, in this otherwise fast printer, was that while printing borderless, some portion of the image leaked into the perforated sides. The colours are quite vibrant. But we noticed a prominent layer of dust or some sort of noise on the darker portions of the photograph. This may be due to microscopic dust being deposited on the photo before the overcoating. We tried our best to print it in a clean environment, but the noise never reduced. We couldn't compare this printer to the others in this for the sake of fairness.

Price: ₹5,995

